

Peblo – Filmmaker Creative Direction Challenge

Project:

Fox and Swan – Scene 3 & 4 (Preview Review)

Submitted by

Shreya Midya

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Part 1: Timestamp-Based Video Feedback

Scene 3 & 4 – Preview Review

00:00 – 00:08

The opening of the scene creates a peaceful and magical atmosphere. The morning mist and pond look beautiful, but I think the scene can feel even more immersive if the camera slowly moves forward instead of staying mostly static. Adding small details like birds flying across the frame, gentle ripples in the water, or floating leaves would make the environment feel more alive. A soft flute with light nature sounds would also help the audience connect with the magical world from the very beginning.

00:09 – 00:20

The Swan's entrance is graceful and suits her character well. To make this moment more memorable, I would include a close-up of her wings touching the water and a reflection shot before revealing her completely. A slow camera movement following her across the pond would make her appear more elegant and magical. This also helps children immediately understand that she is a special character.

00:21 – 00:34

When Dhoomi notices The Swan, his expressions should clearly show curiosity and greed. Instead of only showing him watching from a distance, I would add a close-up of his eyes, slight tail movement, and ears lifting as he becomes interested in the glowing swan. These small body movements make the character feel more natural and expressive.

00:35 – 00:50

The golden egg reveal is one of the most important moments in the story. I would slow this moment slightly and increase the magical glow around the egg. A few sparkling particles and a soft magical sound effect would make the reveal feel more exciting for young viewers. Immediately after showing the egg, I would cut to Dhoomi's reaction to highlight the contrast between Swan's innocence and Dhoomi's growing greed.

00:51 – 01:05

As Dhoomi walks toward The Swan, his body language should reflect that he is pretending to be friendly. His smile can be slightly exaggerated while his eyes secretly keep looking at the golden egg. This creates dramatic irony because the audience understands his real intention even though swan does not.

01:06 – 01:28

The conversation between Dhoomi and The Swan is clear, but it would feel stronger with more reaction shots. After every important dialogue, the camera should briefly show the other character's expression before continuing. This gives children enough time to understand how each character is feeling and makes the conversation feel more natural.

01:29 – 01:44

When Dhoomi lies about the hunter, I would reduce the background music and let the forest become quieter. Swan's eyes should widen slightly, and her wings can move closer to her body to show fear. A short pause before Dhoomi continues speaking would build suspense and make the lie feel more convincing.

01:45 – 02:02

When Dhoomi offers to protect The Swan, his voice should sound calm and caring, but his expressions should reveal his hidden greed. A quick glance toward the golden egg while he is speaking would subtly show his true intention without needing additional dialogue.

02:03 – End

The Swan's decision feels important, so I would allow a slightly longer pause before she agrees. Showing her looking at her nest, then at Dhoomi, and finally giving a small nod would make her decision feel more emotional. At the end, after Dhoomi bows, I would include one final close-up of his face where his fake smile slowly changes into a satisfied expression. This would end the scene on a stronger emotional note and create curiosity for what happens next.

Part 2: Creative References

Reference	What I Referenced
Zootopia	Character expressions, facial animation, and animal body language.
The Lion King (2019)	Forest atmosphere, lighting, and emotional close-up shots.
Kung Fu Panda	Humour timing, expressive reactions, and cinematic camera movement.
Bluey	Child-friendly storytelling, emotional pacing, and simple visual communication.

Conclusion

Overall, the preview has a strong visual style and successfully creates a magical atmosphere for children. With more expressive character animation, dynamic camera angles, improved pacing, and enhanced sound design, the scenes can become even more engaging and emotionally impactful. These small creative changes would help strengthen the storytelling while keeping it enjoyable for the target audience.